

Windows Server vs Ubuntu Server vs Rocky Linux

Category	Windows Server	Ubuntu Server	Rocky Linux
Licensing	Commercial/proprietary with evaluation options	Open-source with optional commercial support	Open-source with enterprise-oriented support ecosystem
User Interface	Strong graphical administration options	Primarily command-line/ server focused, graphical interfaces can be installed	Primarily command-line/ server focused
Package Management	Windows package and update management tools	APT	DNF
Security	Strong security controls, Windows security ecosystem and Active Directory integration	Linux security model, permissions, firewall tools and frequent security updates	Enterprise Linux security model, SELinux and controlled package ecosystem
Performance	Strong performance for Windows-based workloads	Efficient and suitable for many server workloads	Efficient and designed for enterprise server workloads
Typical Enterprise Use	Active Directory, Windows applications, Microsoft services, file/print services	Web servers, development, cloud services, databases, internal services	Enterprise Linux environments, servers, applications and infrastructure
Advantages	Excellent Microsoft ecosystem integration and graphical administration	Free/open-source, flexible, widely used and developer-friendly	Enterprise-oriented, stable, compatible with the RHEL ecosystem
Disadvantages	Licensing costs and greater dependence on Microsoft ecosystem	Some tasks require Linux command-line knowledge	May require more Linux administration knowledge
Best Fit	Organizations heavily using Microsoft technologies	Development, web, cloud and general Linux server environments	Organizations wanting an enterprise-focused Linux platform

Discussion

Windows Server, Ubuntu Server, and Rocky Linux are all capable enterprise operating systems, but they have different strengths. Windows Server is particularly appropriate for organizations that depend heavily on Microsoft technologies. It provides strong integration with Microsoft services and offers graphical

administration tools that can make some management tasks easier for administrators familiar with Windows.

Ubuntu Server provides a flexible open-source environment and is widely suitable for web hosting, software development, cloud services, databases, and internal infrastructure. Its package management system and large Linux ecosystem make it useful for organizations that require flexibility without the licensing model associated with proprietary server operating systems.

Rocky Linux is another open-source Linux server operating system designed for enterprise environments. It follows the broader Enterprise Linux ecosystem and is appropriate for organizations that value stability and compatibility with enterprise-oriented Linux software.

For ABC Startup Solutions, Ubuntu Server is a practical choice because the company is a software development startup and the Week 3 project specifically requires an Ubuntu Server deployment. Ubuntu provides a flexible platform for future web hosting, databases, file sharing, internal services, and development-related infrastructure.

The choice of operating system should ultimately depend on the organization's applications, technical expertise, security requirements, budget, support requirements, and existing infrastructure.